NARRATIIVE

GROWTH BLUEPRINT / 2026

KatKin

The science cats deserve

From category claim to category authority



INTERNAL REVIEW DRAFT - HUMAN APPROVAL REQUIRED

The brief isn't 'build more brand awareness' - it's 'find what only KatKin can prove'

Wrong question: how to out-spend or out-create competitors on reach, given KatKin already runs 300+ active paid-social ads and ships roughly 114 new creatives a week. Right question: what can KatKin claim permanently that a funded rival cannot replicate in one ad cycle, and does that claim still work once personalisation disappears at retail. This Blueprint answers the diagnosis and activation sequencing; full



COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCE

Redirects the CMO mandate from spend-led awareness building toward asset-led differentiation, changing what gets resourced next quarter.

SOURCES: S5, T1

APPROVED STRATEGY + VERIFIED FACT

Five forces are closing the window, and none are solved by more paid reach

SAMENESS

Shared functional language

ECONOMICS

Paid creative pressure

THE PRESSURE

Category functional language has commoditised across DTC entrants. Discovery is shifting toward organic and AI search, where a lower-funded rival currently leads. Paid-social costs keep

DISCOVERY

Organic and AI search shift

MANDATE

Build a loved brand

COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCE

Establishes urgency to act within the current planning cycle, directly tied to a loss-making position that shortens the decision window.

SOURCES: S1A, S1B, S1C, S3, S5

INTERPRETATION + VERIFIED FACT

Every brand says the same thing; only one has the published proof to say something else



THE HARD PART IS ALREADY DONE

Across DTC competitors, 'real meat, no fillers, vet-formulated' is now shared vocabulary - Untamed uses it near-verbatim on a fraction of KatKin's funding. No competitor has claimed independent, peer-reviewed proof as owned territory, because publishing research is slow and costly - which is exactly why it is defensible. This

COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCE

Converting this gap into owned territory could reduce reliance on functional-claim parity and support earned, not only paid, discovery - a mechanism, not a guaranteed outcome.

SOURCES: S2, S3

INTERPRETATION + VERIFIED FACT

KatKin did the hard, expensive part of proof - and is marketing the easy, copyable part instead

WHAT OWNERS SEE

Confident claims

Fresh. Real meat. Vet formulated.

THE GAP

WHAT KATKIN CAN PROVE

Independent science

The tension at the centre of this Blueprint: owners are shown assertion-led claims when KatKin's real edge is evidence-led. Whether consumers reward independently verified proof over confident assertion, at the speed of a retail glance or a

COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCE

Forces an explicit choice before committing production budget: build around proof (higher differentiation, higher validation risk) or stay on shared claims (lower risk, no new

SOURCES: S2

VERIFIED FACT

KatKin's loudest signal reaches the one audience it has already won

01

COMMITTED DTC

Prevents over-resourcing creative for an audience that is already converting, at the expense of the two pools

02

RETAIL CONVERT

Current messaging centres the committed DTC subscriber who completes a quiz and receives a personalised plan - the audience already captured. Growth

03

MAINSTREAM OWNER

Prevents over-resourcing creative for an audience that is already converting, at the expense of the two pools

COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCE

Prevents over-resourcing creative for an audience that is already converting, at the expense of the two pools carrying the real growth prize.

SOURCES: S4, S6

MIXED FACT AND HYPOTHESIS + VERIFIED FACT

Three growth pools need three different jobs from the same proof

01

COMMITTED DTC

Directs investment sequencing by evidence confidence, not assumed importance - the mainstream pool should be

02

RETAIL CONVERT

Committed DTC (observed): motivated by proof and a cat-as-family belief, already paying a premium. Affluent retail converts (partially observed): buy

03

MAINSTREAM OWNER

Directs investment sequencing by evidence confidence, not assumed importance - the mainstream pool should be

COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCE

Directs investment sequencing by evidence confidence, not assumed importance - the mainstream pool should be validated before media spend is committed to it.

SOURCES: S4

MIXED FACT AND HYPOTHESIS

The trust-builder that works in a DTC quiz cannot survive three seconds on a shelf

01

DISCOVERY

Prevents a single creative asset being asked to do five different jobs; each stage gets its own measurable

02

DECISION

Mapped by mechanism: discovery happens mostly through paid social and, for competitors, organic and AI search; consideration and trust-building

03

REPEAT

Prevents a single creative asset being asked to do five different jobs; each stage gets its own measurable

COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCE

Prevents a single creative asset being asked to do five different jobs; each stage gets its own measurable mechanism and owner.

SOURCES: S4, S6, S7

MIXED FACT AND HYPOTHESIS + VERIFIED FACT

Decision one: what KatKin stands for - proof, not promise

POSITION	Proof, not promise
BENEFIT	Confidence without self-audit
PLATFORM	The science cats deserve
EXPRESSION	Visible without personalisation

COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCE

Gives every team one falsifiable sentence to brief from, replacing today's message drift across paid, CRM and retail.

SOURCES: S2, S3, T1

APPROVED STRATEGY + INTERPRETATION + VERIFIED FACT

Decision two: what the owner should feel - confidence, not persuasion

POSITION	Proof, not promise
BENEFIT	Confidence without self-audit
PLATFORM	The science cats deserve
EXPRESSION	Visible without personalisation

COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCE

If validated, shifts creative briefs from 'prove the food works' to 'prove you don't need to take our word for it' - a different commercial case for performance-marketing teams.

SOURCES: S2, S4, T1

APPROVED STRATEGY + MIXED FACT AND HYPOTHESIS + VERIFIED FACT

Decision three: the story that carries it - 'The Science Cats Deserve'

1

TENSION

The category asks owners to trust claims

2

SHIFT

KatKin makes proof the starting point

3

RESOLUTION

Independent science carries the decision

THE SCIENCE CATS DESERVE

COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCE

One flexible story could reduce reliance on the current high-volume weekly creative production needed to sustain differentiation, if the shelf and CRM translations hold up under

SOURCES: S2, T1

APPROVED STRATEGY + VERIFIED FACT

Decision four: how it shows up unaided - one proof, three executions

MASTER MESSAGE

Nutrition proven, not promised

Master message: nutrition proven, not promised. Proof layers: published in a peer-reviewed journal; formulated by a Board-Certified Veterinary Nutritionist; vertically integrated production. Objection to pre-empt: isn't all

PUBLISHED

Peer-reviewed research

FORMULATED

Board-Certified Veterinary Nutritionist

MADE

Vertically integrated production

COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCE

Equips CRM and retail teams with one shared brief instead of two diverging narratives, reducing coordination cost between DTC and retail functions.

SOURCES: S2, T1

APPROVED STRATEGY + VERIFIED FACT

The prize is pricing power and cheaper growth - not simply more reach

EARNED

A citable point of view

RETAIL

Premium proof at shelf

CRM

Segmented confidence

INVESTOR

Earlier leading signals

COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCE

Frames the shift in terms investors already track - pricing power and CAC - without asserting unverified numbers.

SOURCES: S1A, S2, S5, S8

THIRD PARTY ESTIMATE + VERIFIED FACT

NARRATIIVE

Retail has three seconds to do what CRM does in three emails

DTC QUIZ	Discovery and education	Personalised
CRM	Trust and retention	First party
RETAIL	Conversion	Unaided
EARNED / SEARCH	Scale discovery	Citable
PAID SOCIAL	Volume	Rebalanced

COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCE

Rebalances channel investment toward mechanisms that can compound without continuous paid spend, directly answering the rising-CAC constraint named earlier.

SOURCES: S5, S6, S7

VERIFIED FACT

NARRATIIVE

Validate before you commit - founder sign-off gates the final narrative lock

DAYS 1-30

Foundation

Founder pressure-test and evidence audit

DAYS 31-60

Prove

Retail translation and CRM pilot

DAYS 61-90

Scale

Shift spend only when leading signals move

COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCE

Sequences spend so the cheapest, highest-confidence validation step happens before any retail or creative production investment is committed.

SOURCES: S4, S6

MIXED FACT AND HYPOTHESIS + VERIFIED FACT

Prove the shift is working before revenue can show it

LEADING / 3-6 MONTHS	Claim recognition, shelf comprehension, earned search share
LAGGING	Retail sell-through, blended CAC trend, subscriber retention
COMMERCIAL	Price realisation versus discount dependency

COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCE

Gives the founder and investors a credible early read on strategy health ahead of the stated runway checkpoint, directly addressing the loss-making position named at the outset.

SOURCES: S1A, S1B

VERIFIED FACT

The quantified opportunity

Scenario	Target share	Revenue upside	Contribution	Margin assumption
Conservative	2.25%	£1.50m	£0.45m	30%
Base	2.50%	£3.00m	£1.20m	40%
Ambitious	3.00%	£6.00m	£3.00m	50%

ILLUSTRATIVE SCENARIOS. MARKET SHARE AND CONTRIBUTION MARGIN ARE ASSUMPTIONS, NOT COMPANY FORECASTS.

COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCE

A 0.5-point share gain implies about £3.0m in incremental annual revenue in the base scenario.

SOURCES: S8, S1A

ESTIMATE + ASSUMPTION

What the model can and cannot say

SOURCED INPUTS

Estimated UK cat food market	£600.00m
KatKin reported UK cat food market share	2%

WHAT REMAINS UNKNOWN

Implementation cost

Not supplied. Net value and payback cannot be calculated responsibly.

Required next: actual margin, CAC, retention and scoped delivery budget.

COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCE

Revenue and contribution are scenario estimates; net value remains unavailable until KatKin supplies implementation cost and unit economics.

SOURCES: S8, S1A

ESTIMATE + EVIDENCE GAP

Creative direction: make proof visible

CLINICAL PRECISION

meets

INTIMATE CAT BEHAVIOUR

01 OBSERVATION

Tight crops and watchful eyes

02 EVIDENCE

Visible marks that show what was checked

03 SIGNAL

One coral cue points to the proof

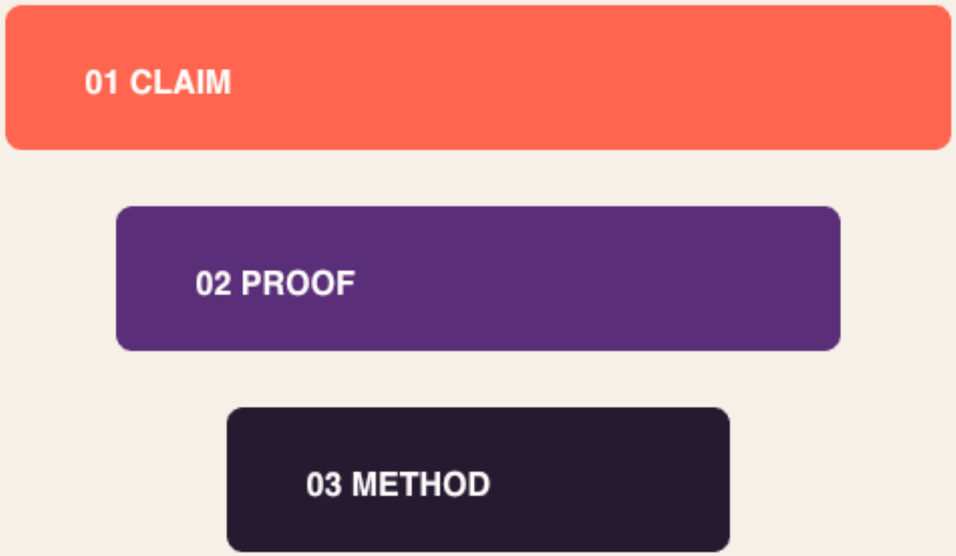
COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCE

A distinctive world turns the published science into a recognisable visual behaviour, not another nutrition claim.

SOURCES: T1, S2

PROPOSED CREATIVE TERRITORY

The proof has to travel in layers



Evidence becomes an acquisition asset only when it is both quick to grasp and deep enough to inspect.

COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCE

Lead with one human-readable claim, reveal the published evidence behind it, then offer the full method for those who want to inspect it.

SOURCES: S2, T1

APPROVED STRATEGY

Share gain, not storytelling optimism, drives the upside

0.25pt

≈ £1.5m revenue

0.5pt

≈ £3.0m revenue

1pt

≈ £6.0m revenue

COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCE

Every 0.25 percentage-point move in a £600m market represents roughly £1.5m in annual revenue before contribution assumptions.

SOURCES: S8, S1A

ESTIMATE + ASSUMPTION

Three numbers unlock an investable business case

MARGIN	Actual contribution
COST	Scoped implementation
RETENTION	Observed behaviour

COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCE

Actual contribution margin, the scoped implementation budget and observed retention are the missing inputs needed to calculate net value and payback.

SOURCES: T1

EVIDENCE GAP

NARRATIIVE

The creative system behaves like evidence

01

OBSERVE

Distinctiveness comes from a repeatable behaviour, not decorative variety.

02

MARK

Distinctiveness comes from a repeatable behaviour, not decorative variety.

03

SIGNAL

Distinctiveness comes from a repeatable behaviour, not decorative variety.

COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCE

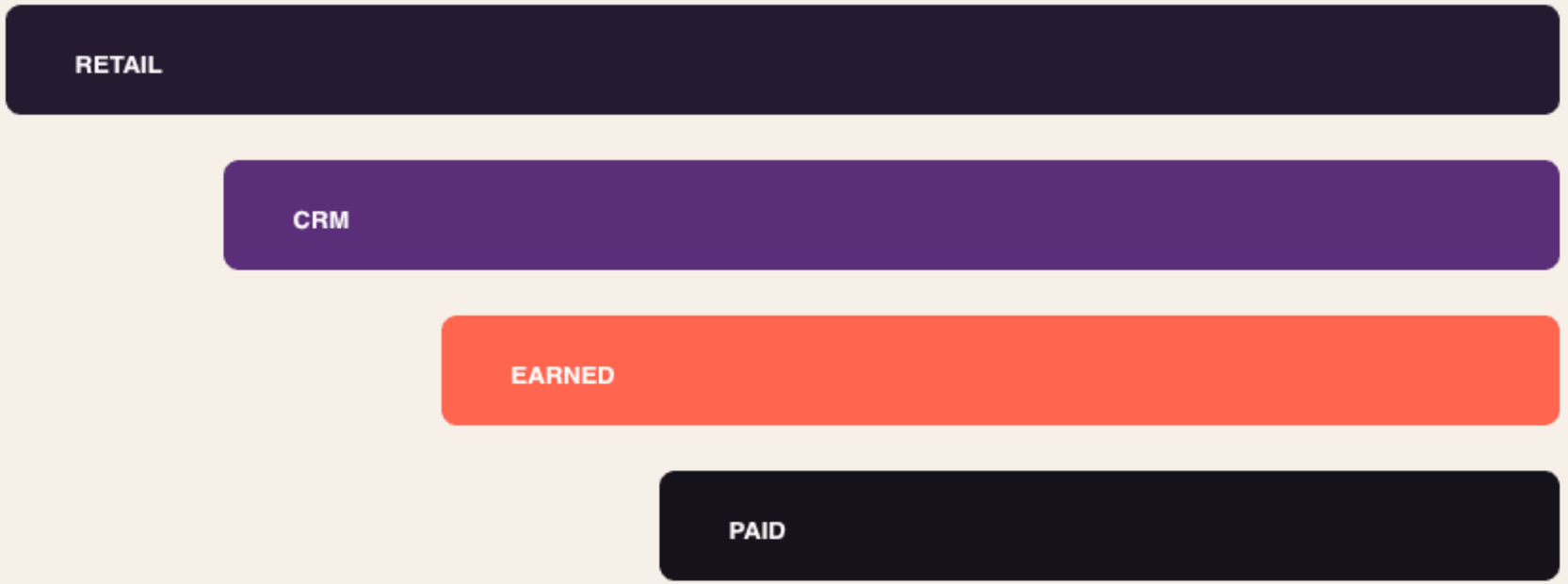
Observation draws the eye; an explicit evidence mark shows what was checked; one coral signal carries the proof across formats.

SOURCES: S2, T1

PROPOSED CREATIVE TERRITORY

NARRATIIVE

One proof, translated for each decision environment



Retail needs instant comprehension, CRM can reveal depth, earned media needs a citable point of view and paid social should create the first moment of intrigue.

COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCE

Retail needs instant comprehension, CRM can reveal depth, earned media needs a citable point of view and paid social should create the first moment of intrigue.

SOURCES: S5, S6, T1

PROPOSED EXECUTION

Test recognition before buying reach

Scale only after the proof-led idea improves leading indicators without weakening conversion.



COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCE

Run a founder pressure-test, a retail comprehension test and a controlled CRM pilot before moving material media investment.

SOURCES: T1

PROPOSED TEST PLAN

The founder decision is deliberately narrow

APPROVE	The strategic territory
COMMISSION	The missing economics
AUTHORISE	A bounded validation

COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCE

Approve the proof-led strategic territory, commission the missing unit-economics inputs and authorise a bounded retail-and-CRM validation programme.

SOURCES: T1

HUMAN DECISION REQUIRED

Source register

ID	Classification	Original source	Location
S1A	verified fact	The Grocer: Series C, market share and 100m-meal scale report (December 2025)	thegrocer.co.uk (Series C report)
S1B	verified fact	Companies House / Companies in the UK: Anikin Ltd statutory accounts and balance sheet (FY2023)	companieshouse.gov.uk; companiesintheuk.co.uk
S1C	verified fact	Marketing Week: Lloyd Page appointed first CMO (2025)	marketingweek.com
S2	verified fact	KatKin / Journal of Animal Science: KatKin heat-damage study and peer-reviewed AGE research (accessed 11 September 2026)	katkin.com/articles/katkins-heat-damage-study; Journal of Animal Science

Classification describes how the Blueprint uses each source. Source URLs and dates remain editable in this deck.

SOURCES: S1A, S1B, S1C, S2

SOURCE REGISTER

Source register continued

ID	Classification	Original source	Location
S3	interpretation	Untamed / Bubblegum Search: Competitor claims and organic-search comparison (Q3 2025 to September 2026)	untamed.com; bubblegumsearch.com
S4	mixed fact and hypothesis	KatKin / Trustpilot / Cats.com: Pricing, reviews and customer-friction evidence (accessed 11 September 2026)	katkin.com/our-pricing; uk.trustpilot.com/review/katkin.com; cats.com/katkin-cat-food-review
S5	verified fact	Motion / Marketing Week: Paid-social volume and creative analysis (accessed 11 September 2026)	motionapp.com/library/katkin; marketingweek.com
S6	verified fact	Pet Business World: Jollyes retail rollout across 80 stores (August 2025)	petbusinessworld.co.uk

Classification describes how the Blueprint uses each source. Source URLs and dates remain editable in this deck.

SOURCES: S3, S4, S5, S6

SOURCE REGISTER

Source register continued

ID	Classification	Original source	Location
S7	verified fact	Active Partners: Series B strategy and retail partnership context (30 November 2023)	active.partners
S8	third party estimate	Research & Markets: UK cat food market estimate, USD 765.91m (2025 report)	researchandmarkets.com
T1	approved strategy	Narratiive governed workflow: Approved KatKin Strategy Thesis (September 2026)	artifact-63f71c6bacf78fe6-92b790e0f4def86f

Classification describes how the Blueprint uses each source. Source URLs and dates remain editable in this deck.

SOURCES: S7, S8, T1

SOURCE REGISTER

Stop competing on the claim anyone can copy. Compete on the proof no one else has.

Own the proof.

Make it easy to feel.

Then earn the right to scale.

IMMEDIATE NEXT STEP

Founder pressure-test and retail translation test